



BET**MGM**

Sportsbook Behavioral Deep Dive  
Behavioral Study  
June 2025

# OUR BRAND RESEARCH JOURNEY

Q1-Q2 2024

## MINDSET

CUSTOMER DEFINITION/  
BRAND HEALTH SURVEY

Q3-Q4 2024

## MESSAGING

SPORTSBOOK FOUNDATIONAL  
MESSAGING/RTB STUDY

Q1-Q2 2025

## BEHAVIORS

SPORTSBOOK BEHAVIORAL DEEP  
DIVE STUDY

# RESEARCH OBJECTIVE + METHODOLOGY

## BACKGROUND & OBJECTIVE

### THE WHAT

This research explores how sports bettors across our segments engage with the category. We aimed to understand how behaviors, motivations and brand experience perceptions differ across key segments

### THE WHY

To identify how the brand and product experience can evolve and improve, to align with the brand strategy and drive growth & retention.

## METHODOLOGY

We surveyed 2,142 active sports bettors in legal U.S. states and Canada (p30d).

Respondents were sourced via BetMGM CX (internal sample, n=1,343) and Qualtrics (external sample, n=824), split across three segments:

Elite n=903

Experienced n=729

Experimenting n=535

# WHO WE TALKED TO BY SEGMENT

|                                   | Overall      | Elite                              | Experienced                        | Experimenting                      |
|-----------------------------------|--------------|------------------------------------|------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| Average Age                       | <b>41</b>    | <b>41</b><br>(overindex for 31-50) | <b>42</b><br>(overindex for 51-64) | <b>41</b><br>(overindex for 21-30) |
| Average HHI                       | <b>\$95K</b> | <b>\$99K</b>                       | <b>\$108K</b>                      | <b>\$74K</b>                       |
| % of Men                          | <b>86%</b>   | <b>84%</b>                         | <b>90%</b>                         | <b>88%</b>                         |
| % betting few times per week+     | <b>83%</b>   | <b>85%</b>                         | <b>85%</b>                         | <b>76%</b>                         |
| Bets placed per session           | <b>4.6</b>   | <b>5.4</b>                         | <b>3.9</b>                         | <b>4.2</b>                         |
| Average amount wagered each month | <b>\$905</b> | <b>\$1,341</b>                     | <b>\$713</b>                       | <b>\$505</b>                       |

# SEGMENTS TAKEAWAYS

## KEY SEGMENT TAKEAWAYS

### #1

Elite bettors are power users who crave premium, immersive betting experiences that go beyond the wager.

### #2

Experienced bettors are strategic players who value utility, efficiency, and smart rewards.

## TAKEAWAY #1

Elite bettors are power users who crave premium, immersive betting experiences that go beyond the wager.

They don't want to browse, they want the best action delivered to them.

**ELITE**

Elite bettors aren't just active. They bet more, interact more, and immerse themselves in the entire betting ecosystem.

# 56%

of Elite bettors place more than 5 bets per session, nearly doubling the rate of Non-Elites.

# 3x

**more likely** to follow sportsbooks on social media compared to Non-Elites.

# 79%

of Elites say its important that the MGM Rewards program offers them perks at MGM casinos and hotels.

# ELITE

Elite bettors also show activity across a wide variety of sports and bet types, underscoring their desire for exciting action wherever and whenever they can find it.

## 40%

(122)

Of Elite bettors wager on  
“Team Futures” markets

## 29%

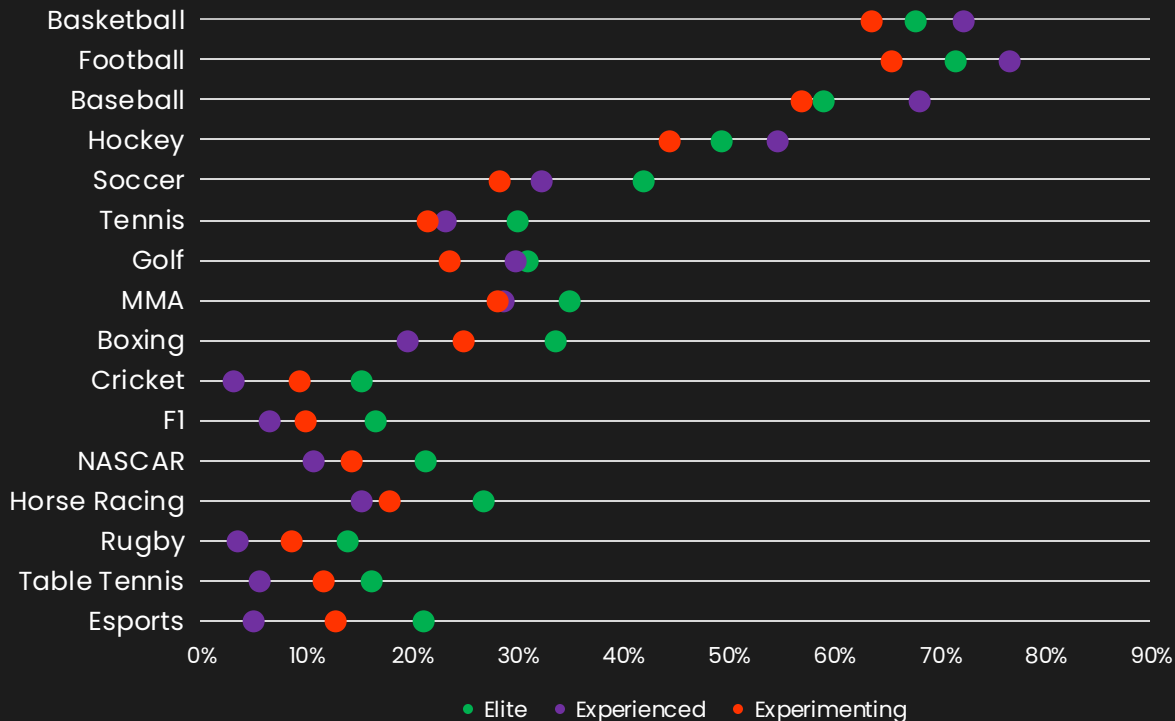
(124)

Of Elite bettors wager on  
“Player Futures” markets

## 18%

(117)

Of Elite bettors wager on  
“Novelty Props” markets

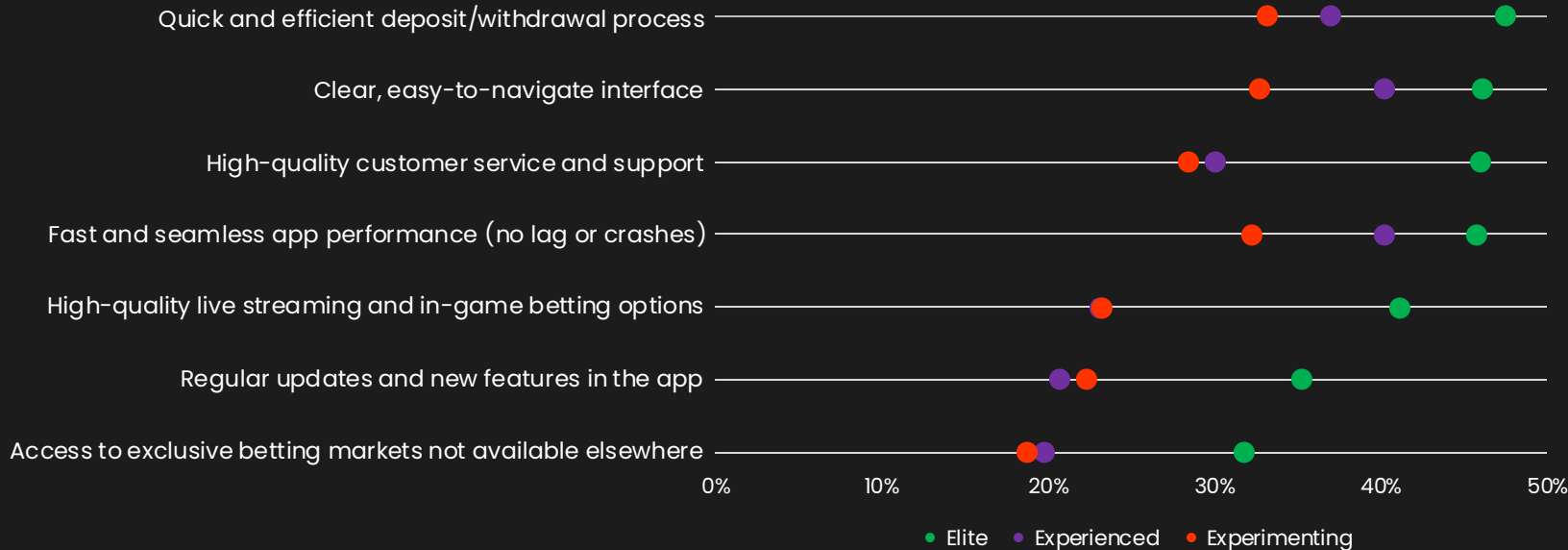


**ELITE**  
Elite bettors' varied interests are also highlighted by their strong interest in a wide variety of types of promotions that help keep their experience new and exciting



**ELITE**  
 Platforms must deliver fast, intuitive tools and premium interfaces that mirror the sophistication of the Elites' play style. If the experience feels clunky or dated, they'll leave.

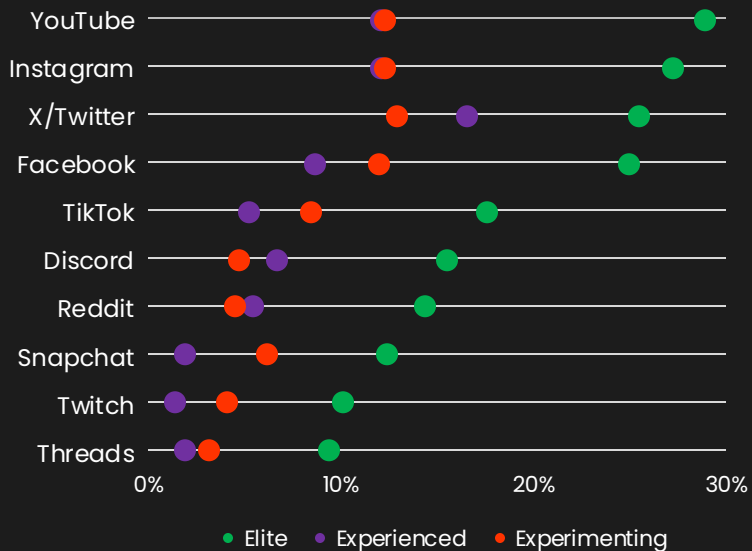
What makes a sportsbook app feel like a premium experience to you?



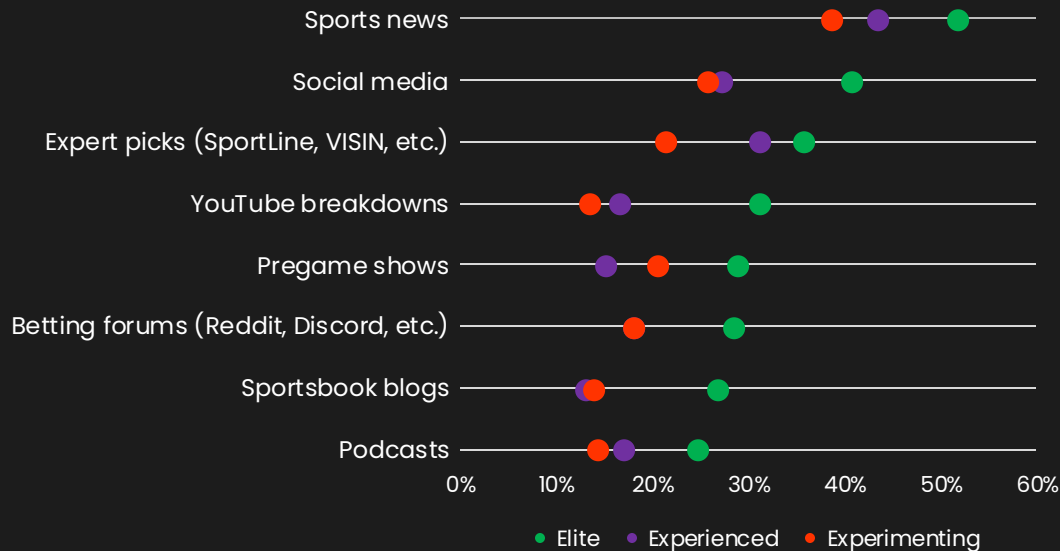
# IMPLICATION

They aren't loyal to one app unless it meets their expectations for personalization, performance, and presence beyond the bet. To win the Elites over, BetMGM must show up where these bettors already are.

Which platforms do you go to most, for betting-related content?



What types of betting-related content influence your bets?



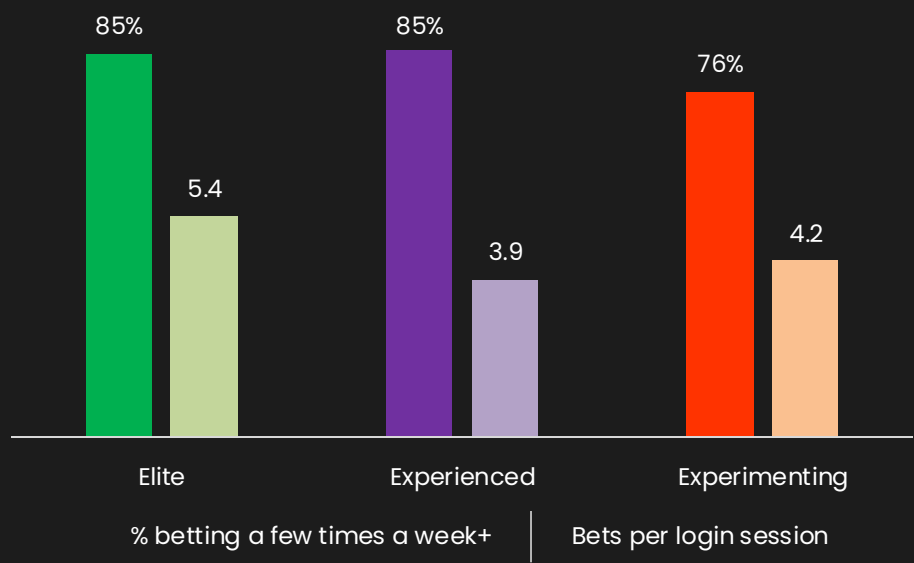
## TAKEAWAY #2

Experienced bettors are strategic players who value utility, efficiency, and smart rewards.

They stick with platforms that consistently help them bet smarter.

## EXPERIENCED

Experienced bettors bet as often as Elites, but place fewer per session favoring strategy over volume.



## EXPERIENCED

Compared to other segments, Experienced bettors are seeking value above all else, but many can be enticed by personalized promos for their preferred sports without a lot of red tape

# 71%

(114)

Of Experienced bettors say “Value”  
is the most important aspect of  
**sportsbook promos**

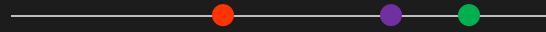
# 59%

(119)

Of Experienced bettors say “Value”  
is the most important aspect of  
**sportsbook rewards programs**

### Most important aspect of sportsbook promotions

Availability for my preferred sport



Simple bet requirements



Personalized offers based on my preferences



25% 30% 35% 40% 45% 50%

● Elite ● Experienced ● Experimenting

# IMPLICATION

To win with Experienced bettors, focus on function over flash.

Deliver fast, dependable tools then let your product prove its worth over a beautiful interface.

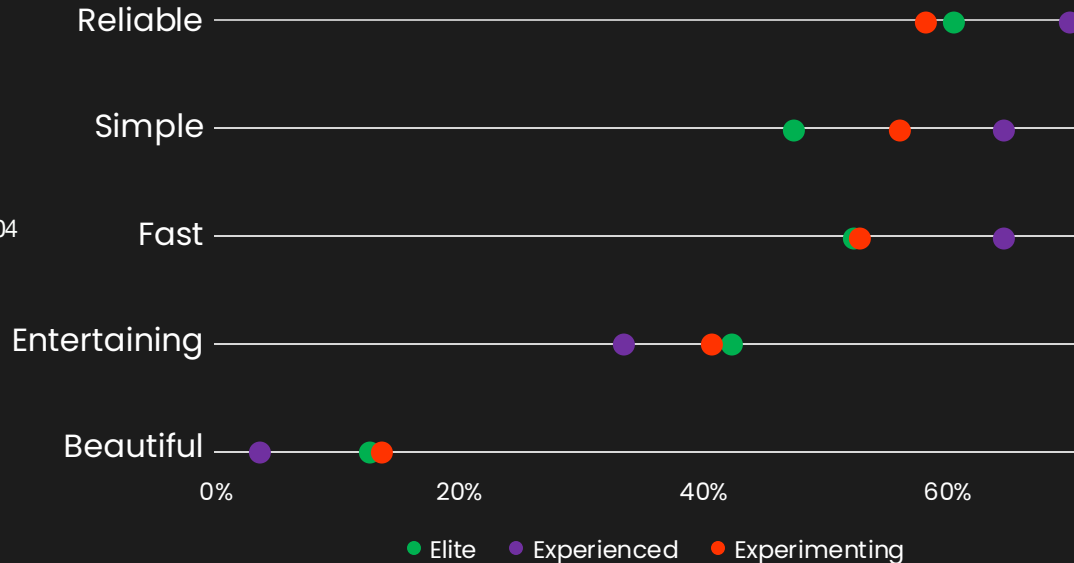
Most Important Promo Features

#1 Value (71%)<sub>114</sub>

#2 Frequency (46%)<sub>105</sub>

#3 Simple Conditions (43%)<sub>104</sub>

Most important descriptors of an online sportsbook experience



# BEHAVIORAL TAKEAWAYS

## KEY BEHAVIORAL TAKEAWAYS

### #1

Exclusive rewards and high-end access are key to driving Elite exploration.

### #2

Consistency across the experience builds the trust that keeps bettors coming back.

### #3

Clear, compelling value matters more than how personalized an offer feels.

### #4

New users won't stick around without a standout reason to stay.

Prospects: Anyone who primarily uses any other app besides BetMGM.

## TAKEAWAY #1

**Exclusive rewards and high-end access are key to driving Elite exploration.**

High-tier rewards, Vegas perks, and elite access spark interest and sign-ups for Elite bettors.

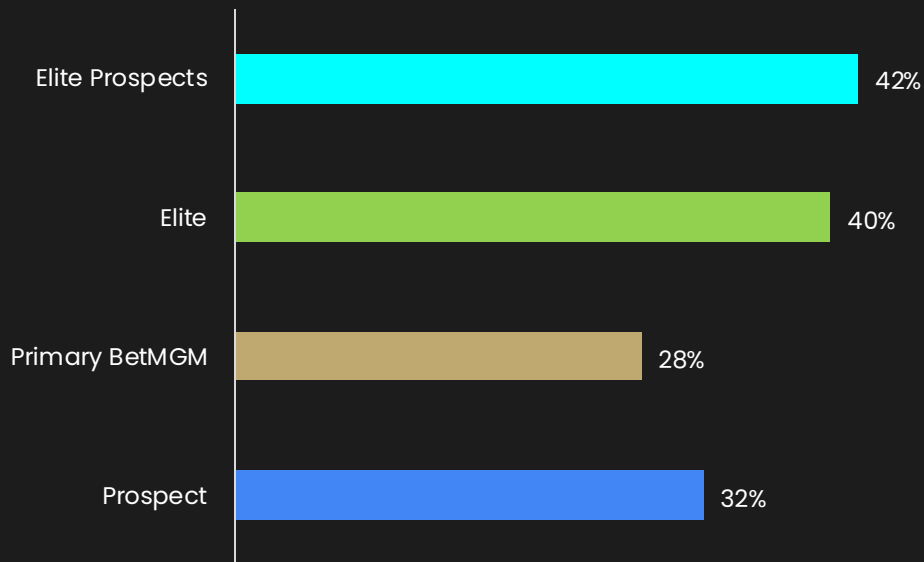
**Elite prospects aren't just betting fans. They're Vegas fans  
and want to be rewarded for the risks they take.**

**88%**

Of elite prospects feel very  
positive toward Las Vegas.

Vegas, status, and exclusive rewards drive elite prospects seeking a product that delivers VIP treatment.

VIP Treatment is important to me as a benefit of a sportsbook rewards program



Las Vegas isn't just a destination, it's a driver. For elite prospects, it powers the perception of premium.

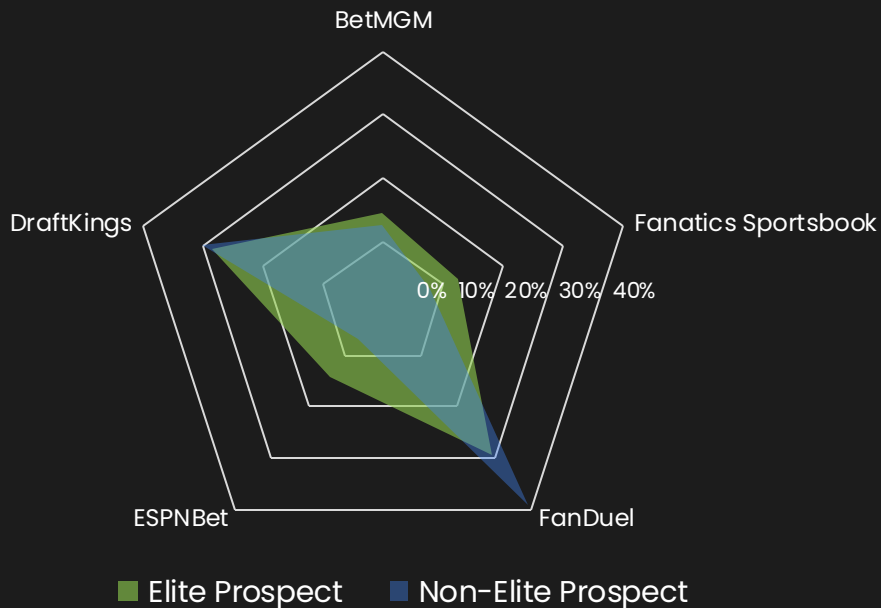
91%

Of elite prospects players  
are attracted to the  
spectacle of Las Vegas.

# IMPLICATION

Elite Prospects are shopping around for the best app experience, while Non-Elites gravitate towards the most popular brands: FanDuel and DraftKings

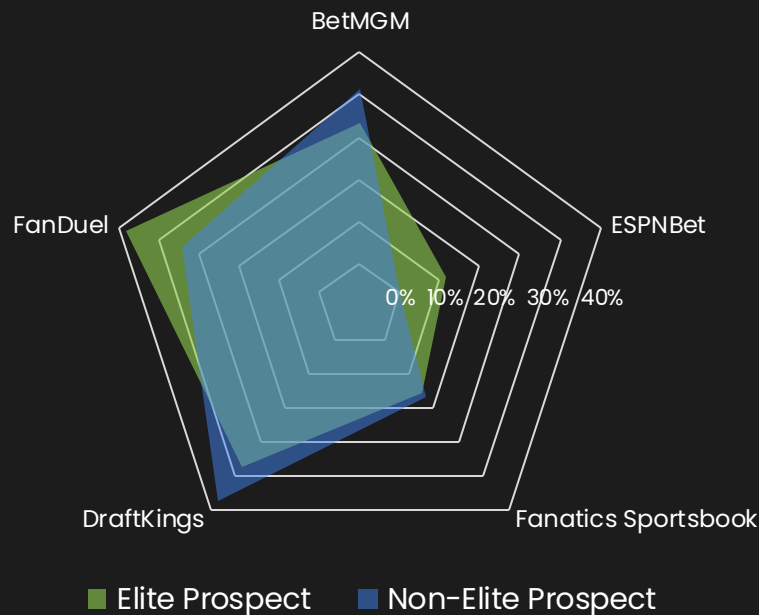
Which brand has the best app interface/user experience?



# IMPLICATION

But BetMGM goes beyond by delivering Vegas, status, and exclusive rewards. It's not just player perks, but proof of a truly strong loyalty experience in the category.

Which brand has the strongest loyalty or rewards program?



## TAKEAWAY #2

**Consistency across the experience  
builds the trust that keeps bettors  
coming back.**

Bettors stick around when the experience feels reliable and elevated from polished design to ongoing promos.

**BetMGM already owns confidence, now it's time to deepen that trust through every touchpoint.**

**73%**

Of Primary BetMGM  
players associate the  
brand with Confidence.

V.S.

**18%**

Associating DraftKings with  
Confidence

**18%**

Associating FanDuel with  
Confidence

Confidence starts with the brand, but sportsbook rewards prove it everyday.

Please describe in detail why sportsbook rewards programs are or are not valuable

"When odds are equal, I defer to BetMGM because **I know my bets are contributing toward rewards that I can benefit from**, like destinations like Las Vegas and discounted room rates I get for being a rewards member."

"Sportsbook rewards programs have been pretty valuable to me. I don't bet constantly, but I do it often enough that the rewards start to add up. **I like that I'm getting something back just for doing something I enjoy anyway. It's a nice extra layer that makes the experience more engaging.**"

"**Some sportsbook rewards programs are not worth the hype. The return on investment is often minimal** unless you're betting very high amounts and some rewards are locked behind unrealistic wagering requirements or are only valid for specific sports or types of bets, which limits their usefulness."

"Sportsbook rewards programs can be quite valuable if you bet regularly, **but if you're a casual bettor or bet in small amounts, the rewards are very limited and take a long time to accumulate.**"

## IMPLICATION

VIP perks aren't just eye-catching, it's a product advantage that attracts both new and existing users, while also being the unlock to BetMGM's premium experience.

VIP or loyalty rewards programs with valuable perks make a sportsbook feel like a premium experience

32%

Primary BetMGM bettors

33%

Prospects

## TAKEAWAY #3

# Clear, compelling value matters more than how personalized an offer feels.

Personalization should amplify value, not replace it. For bettors, legendary value means rewards that are big, frequent, and easy to use. Tailoring helps, but only when it makes the offer feel more rewarding.

Bettors want value first

50%

Of BetMGM bettors say  
meaningful rewards are what  
matter most.

**But personalization is  
what truly makes  
rewards feel premium.**

**Nearly 2/3**

Bettors across all segments say personalization  
motivates players to play with a specific brand.

# QUARTERLY RECAP

*HOW DID YOU PERFORM?*

# OF  
RESORT  
VISITS

1

MOST  
VISITED  
RESORT

PARK MGM

BetMGM Elite bettors value personalized, confidence-building experiences and the product delivers with tailored offers that make every interaction feel rewarding and intentional.

### Attitudes towards personalization features

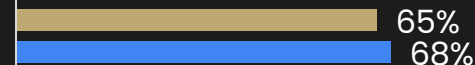


## IMPLICATION

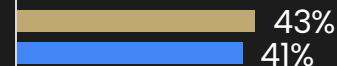
Value gets bettors in the door, but personalization is what makes them stay. To build loyalty, we need to deliver both generous offers and experiences that feel uniquely theirs.

### Attitudes towards personalization features

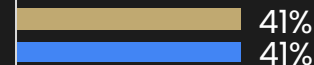
Personalized bonuses based on my betting habits motivates me to play with a specific sportsbook



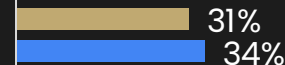
Personalized promotions and bonuses based on my betting history as a new feature



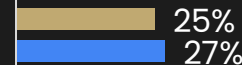
Personalized promotions based on my betting behavior would make a sportsbook feel more premium



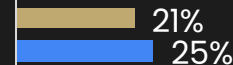
Personalized offers based on my preferences are important features of a sportsbook rewards program



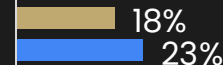
Personalized recommendations and offers make a sportsbook feel premium



Personalization is the most important aspect of sportsbook promotions



I would like to see personalized, AI-driven betting recommendations as a new feature



Q41, Q43, Q46, Q48, Q51, Q52, Q69

## TAKEAWAY #4

# New users won't stick around without a standout reason to stay.

They browse multiple books, looking for excitement, big games, big promos, or a standout experience.

They're holding out for the right moment.

39%

Of prospects place more bets  
during major sporting events,  
which proves timing and  
momentum matters.

And rewards help seal the deal.

59%

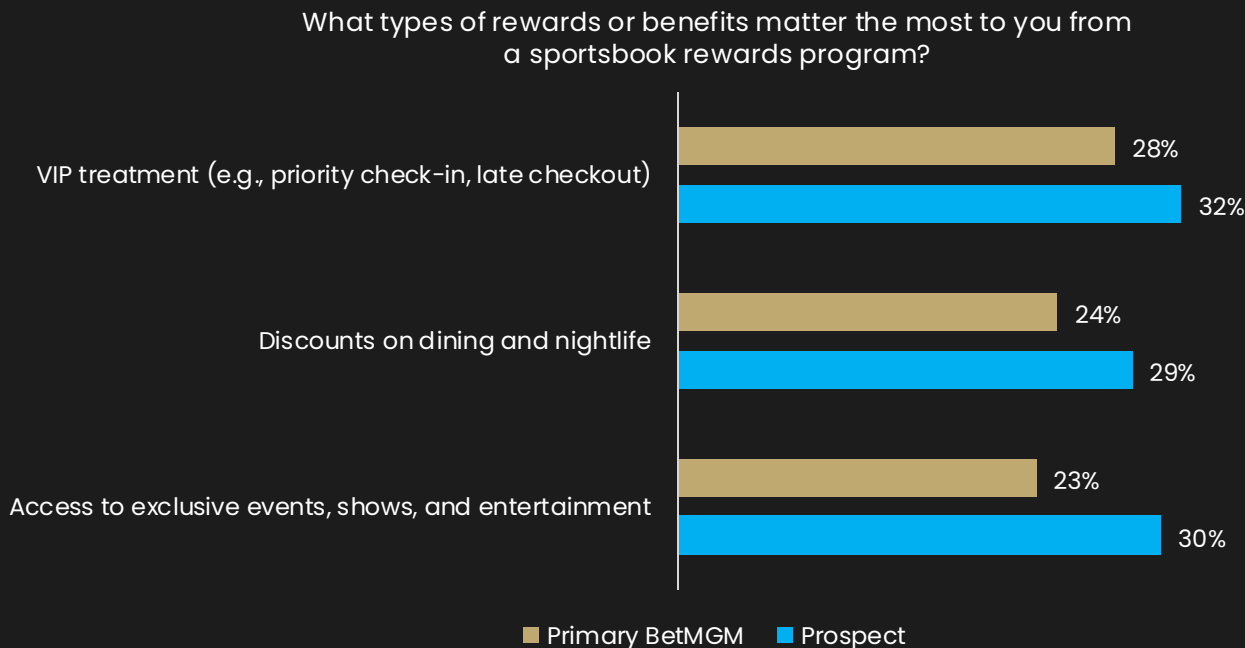
Of prospects say rewards influence which sportsbook they choose proving they're weighing value before committing.

REWARDS THE KING OF REWARDS THE KING OF REWARDS THE KING OF REWARDS THE KING OF REWARDS

ENJOY EXCLUSIVE BENEFITS  
**WITH MARRIOTT BONVOY  
AND BETMGM REWARDS**



For prospects, the right reward isn't just exciting. It's a product feature that connects play to entertainment, exclusivity, and lifestyle value.



Q69. What types of rewards or benefits matter the most to you from a sportsbook rewards program?

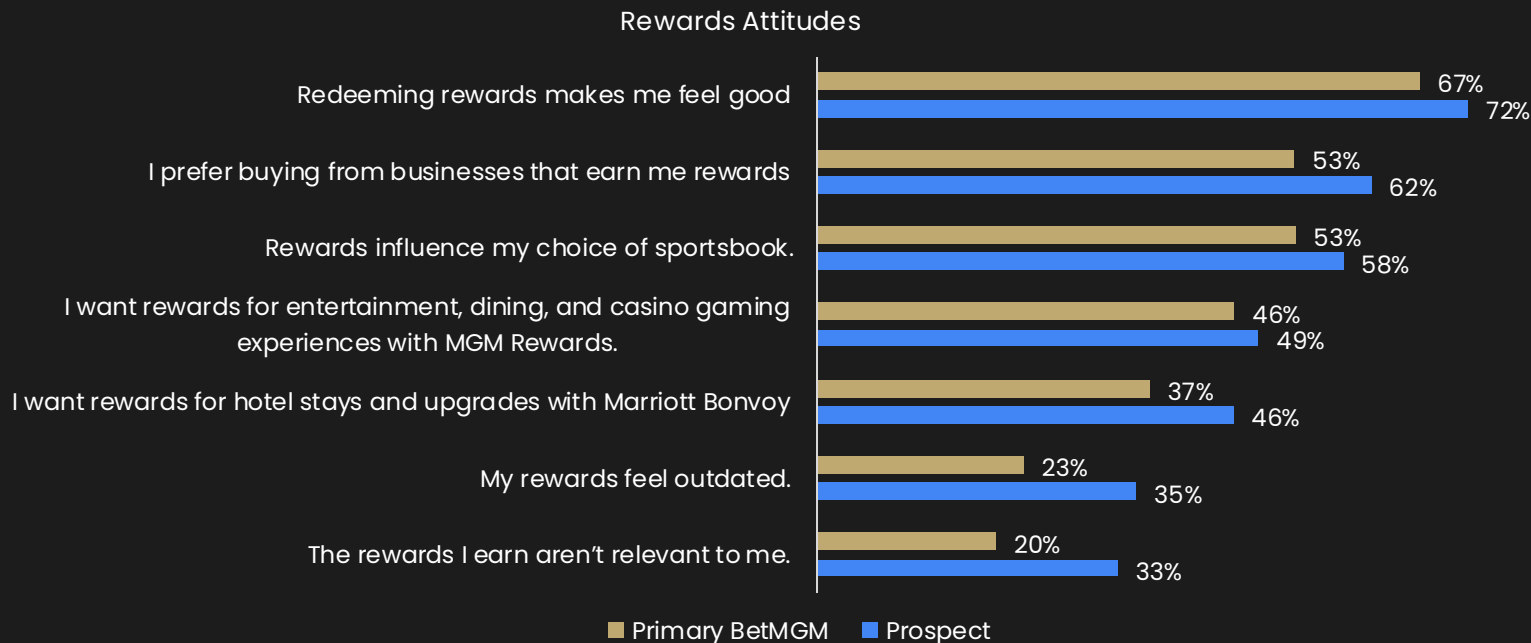
Even without loyalty, they already see the value.

54%

Already see value in sportsbook rewards, even without a primary app, the interest is there.

# IMPLICATION

To turn prospects into loyal players, BetMGM needs more than value. It needs a product that delivers fresh, experience-driven rewards that deepen engagement.



# OVERALL TAKEAWAYS

1.

Elite bettors are power users who crave premium, immersive betting experiences that go beyond the wager.

2.

Experienced bettors prioritize function over flash

3.

Experimenting bettors follow hype, not depth

4.

Exclusive experiences drive exploration

5.

Trust builds through consistent delivery

6.

Clear value matters more than tailored offers

7.

New users need a reason to stay

# THANK YOU!

# APPENDIX

## WHO WE TALKED TO OVERALL

**41**

Avg **Age**

**\$95k**

Avg HHI

**86%**

Men

**83%**

Bet a few times  
per week+

**\$905**

Avg amount wagered  
each month